

Word family: **scene / scenes / scenic / scenery**

Base word: scene

Plural: scenes

Useful related forms: scenic, scenery

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞) / adjective-related family forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “What I admire most is that he can take a small, everyday **scene** and turn it into a story with texture, humour, and meaning.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **scene** means a **small situation, moment, or piece of everyday life that someone can observe happening around them**.

The speaker is not talking about a film or theatre scene. Mr. Wong can notice an ordinary real-life moment—perhaps people waiting for a tram, someone talking in a café, or activity on a street—and turn it into an interesting story.

繁體中文： ** **日常生活中可以被觀察到的一個具體情境、畫面或短暫場面，由當時的人物、行動和環境共同構成**

中文翻譯：

> “...he can take a small, everyday **scene** and turn it into a story with texture, humour, and meaning.”

「.....他可以把一個很小、很日常的**生活場面 / 情境**，說成一個有質感、有幽默感、也有意義的故事。」

Here:

everyday scene = 日常生活中出現的一個具體場面、情境或畫面

1. **scene = situation/view taking place before you (現實中的場面 / 情境) — 場面；情景；畫面**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A particular situation or moment that can be seen or observed, involving people, actions, surroundings, or events.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He can take a small, everyday **scene** and turn it into a story.”

「他可以把一個細小的日常**生活場面**說成一個故事。」

Practice 2

> “The photographer captured a quiet street **scene** early in the morning.”

「攝影師拍下了一個清晨寧靜的街頭**景象 / 場面**。」

Practice 3

> “It was a familiar **scene**: commuters rushing towards the station.”

「那是一個很熟悉的**場面**：通勤的人急忙趕向車站。」

scene = 在某個具體時間和地方可以看到的一個情境、場面或生活畫面

Common:

- * everyday scene
- * street scene
- * familiar scene
- * peaceful scene
- * chaotic scene

These remain one underlying sense.

2. **scene** = part of a play/film/story (戲劇 / 電影 / 故事的一幕) — 一幕；場景

This is one of the most important meanings.

Meaning: A section of a play, film, television programme, or story in which a particular action takes place, usually in one setting or over one continuous period.

Practice 4

> “My favourite **scene** in the film takes place at the railway station.”

「我最喜歡的電影**場景 / 一幕**發生在火車站。」

Practice 5

> “The final **scene** of the play was very emotional.”

「這齣戲的最後一**幕**非常感人。」

scene = 戲劇、電影或故事中構成整體作品的一個相對完整片段，通常發生在特定時間、地方或情節之中

Common:

- * opening scene
- * final scene
- * fight scene
- * romantic scene
- * courtroom scene

These are contextual variations of one core sense.

3. **scene** = place where something happened (事件發生地點) — 現場

Here, **scene** means the physical location where an event, accident, crime, incident, etc. happened.

Practice 6

> “Police arrived at the **scene** within minutes.”

「警方幾分鐘內便趕到**現場**。」

Practice 7

> “Several ambulances were sent to the **scene** of the accident.”

「數輛救護車被派往事故**現場**。」

scene of an event = 某件事故、罪案、事件或其他事情實際發生的地方

Common:

- * crime scene
- * accident scene
- * scene of the fire
- * scene of the incident

The event changes, but the underlying meaning remains:

> **the place where something happened**

4. **scene** = area of social/cultural activity (活動圈 / 界別) — 圈子 ; 界 ; 活動領域

This is an important figurative meaning.

Meaning: The people, places, organizations, and activities connected with a particular cultural, artistic, social, or professional area.

Practice 8

> “She has been part of the local music **scene** for years.”

「她多年來一直活躍於本地音樂**圈 / 界**。」

Practice 9

> “The city has a lively restaurant **scene**.”

「這座城市的餐飲**圈 / 餐飲文化活動**非常活躍。」

scene = 圍繞某種文化、藝術、社交或活動所形成的人物、場所及活動圈子

Common:

- * music scene
- * art scene
- * fashion scene
- * club scene
- * restaurant scene
- * political scene

I would not split these by domain. The broader semantic concept is the same.

5. **scene** = public display of strong emotion (公開吵鬧 / 情緒爆發) — 鬧場 ; 失態場面

This is especially common in:

> **make a scene**

****Meaning:**** A loud, emotional, embarrassing, or disruptive public display.

Practice 10

> “She became angry and made a ****scene**** in the restaurant.”

「她在餐廳發怒，當眾****大吵大鬧 / 鬧了一場****。」

Practice 11

> “I didn’t want to cause a ****scene****, so I left quietly.”

「我不想****當眾鬧出場面 / 引起騷動****，所以安靜地離開了。」

****a scene / make a scene = 在別人面前出現激烈、吵鬧或令人尷尬的情緒表現****

This is genuinely different from an ordinary observed situation.

6. ****scene = view or visual appearance of a place (景象) — 景色 ; 景象****

In some contexts, ****scene**** means what can be seen in a particular place, especially when considered visually as a whole.

Practice 12

> “The window looked out onto a peaceful rural ****scene****.”

「窗外是一片寧靜的鄉村****景象****。」

Practice 13

> “The artist painted a winter ****scene****.”

「那位藝術家畫了一幅冬日****景象****。」

****scene = 某個地方呈現在眼前的整體視覺景象或畫面****

This overlaps with Meaning 1, and I would be conservative here.

For database counting, I would normally ****merge this with the broader visible-situation/view sense in #1****, unless you want an especially fine distinction between:

* ****scene involving an event/situation****

* ****scene as predominantly visual landscape/view****

The Golden Manual says to merge when one broad definition still explains both naturally.

Fixed expression: **behind the scenes — 幕後；在不公開的情況下**

This is a very common expression.

Practice 14

> “A lot of work happens **behind the scenes**.”

「很多工作都是在**幕後**進行的。」

Practice 15

> “She played an important role **behind the scenes**.”

「她在**幕後**發揮了重要作用。」

behind the scenes = 在公眾看不到的地方進行；指幕後工作、安排或影響

This comes originally from theatre, where things literally happened behind the stage scenery, but in modern English it is widely figurative.

I would treat it as a fixed expression rather than another core meaning of **scene**.

Fixed expression: **on the scene — 到場；出現；活躍於某領域**

This has several related uses.

Practice 16

> “Paramedics were quickly **on the scene**.”

「救護人員很快便**到達現場**。」

Practice 17

> “The company arrived **on the scene** in the late 1990s.”

「這家公司在九十年代末**開始出現 / 進入市場**。」

****on the scene** = 到達某件事情發生的地方；或開始出現在某個活動領域中******

These uses grow from the “event location / activity environment” senses.

Fixed expression: ****set the scene** — 交代背景；營造情境******

Practice 18

> “The opening paragraph ****sets the scene**** for the rest of the story.”

「開首一段為故事其餘部分****交代了背景 / 營造了情境****。」

Practice 19

> “Let me ****set the scene**** before I explain what happened.”

「在我解釋發生甚麼之前，先讓我****交代一下當時的背景情況****。」

****set the scene** = 提供背景資料或營造環境，使別人能理解接下來發生的事情******

Again, useful fixed expression rather than a new core lexical sense.

Related form: ****scenic****

****Scenic**** means having attractive or impressive natural views.

Practice 20

> “We took the ****scenic route**** along the coast.”

「我們選擇沿海那條****風景優美的路線****。」

Practice 21

> “The town is surrounded by ****scenic**** mountains.”

「這個小鎮四周都是****風景優美的****山脈。」

****scenic** = 景色優美、值得欣賞自然風景的******

Related form: **scenery**

Scenery means the natural or visual features of a place considered together.

Practice 22

> “The mountain **scenery** was spectacular.”

「山區的**景色 / 風景**非常壯觀。」

Practice 23

> “We stopped several times to enjoy the **scenery**.”

「我們停下來幾次欣賞**風景**。」

scenery = 某個地方呈現在眼前的自然景物和整體景觀

Important:

scenery is normally **uncountable**.

> beautiful scenery 

not normally:

> beautiful sceneries 

for ordinary learner usage.

Important distinction: **scene** vs **scenery**

scene

usually refers to:

- * a particular visible situation;
- * one part of a film/play;
- * an event location;
- * an activity world.

It is **countable**.

> “a street scene”

scenery

refers collectively to the visual features of a landscape.

It is normally **uncountable**.

> “beautiful scenery”

So:

> “The mountain **scenery** was beautiful.”

more natural than:

> “The mountain scenes were beautiful”

unless you mean several separate views/images.

Important distinction: **scene vs setting**

scene

can mean a particular moment or action happening within a place.

setting

focuses more on the surrounding place, time, and circumstances in which something occurs.

For a film:

> **scene** = one section of the action

> **setting** = where/when the story takes place

Example:

> “The café is the **setting** for several important **scenes**.”

「這間咖啡店是幾個重要場景的故事**背景地點**。」

Important distinction: **scene vs situation**

situation

focuses on circumstances or conditions.

scene

often makes the situation more **visual**—something you could imagine seeing.

> “It was a difficult situation.”

= 情況很困難。

> “It was a chaotic scene.”

= 眼前是一片混亂場面。

This visual quality is especially relevant to your original sentence.

Important distinction: **scene vs view**

view

focuses on what can be seen from a particular position.

> “The room has a beautiful view of the harbour.”

scene

usually presents what is seen as a complete situation, picture, or moment.

> “It was a peaceful harbour scene.”

So:

view = 從某個位置望出去所看到的景觀

scene = 被看見的一個完整場面或畫面

Important distinction: **scene vs stage**

These are related in theatre but not the same.

stage

= the physical platform where actors perform

scene

= one section of the dramatic action

A play may have:

- * one stage
- * many scenes

Family-extension note

The useful practical family includes:

- * **scene**
- * **scenes**
- * **scenic**
- * **scenery**

Useful compounds and expressions include:

- * **crime scene**
- * **accident scene**
- * **street scene**
- * **music scene**
- * **opening scene**
- * **final scene**
- * **make a scene**
- * **behind the scenes**
- * **on the scene**
- * **set the scene**

Under the Golden Manual, these compounds and fixed expressions should be included when useful, but they should not automatically become separate meanings if the same broader semantic concept explains them.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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scene — visible situation/everyday moment	在某個具體時間和地方可以觀察到、由人物、行動及環境共同構成的一個場面或情境
scene — part of film/play/story	電影、戲劇或故事中構成整體作品的一個相對完整片段或一幕
scene — place where an event happened	某宗事故、罪案、事件或其他事情實際發生的現場
scene — social/cultural sphere	圍繞某種文化、藝術、社交或活動形成的人物、場所和活動圈子
a scene / make a scene	在公眾面前出現激烈、吵鬧、情緒化或令人尷尬的表現
scene — visual view/image	某個地方呈現在眼前的整體視覺景象；與一般「可見場面」義高度相關
scenic	景色優美、適合欣賞自然風光的
scenery	某個地方呈現在眼前的自然景物和整體景觀；通常為不可數名詞
behind the scenes	在公眾看不到的幕後進行工作、安排或施加影響
set the scene	提供背景資料或營造情境，使別人理解之後的事情

For your original sentence

> “...he can take a small, everyday ****scene**** and turn it into a story with texture, humour, and meaning.”

The exact meaning is:

****scene = 日常生活中可以被觀察到的一個具體場面、情境或畫面****

More specifically:

****small, everyday scene = 看似平凡、短暫，但包含人物、行動和環境細節的日常生活場面****

So:

> ****a small, everyday scene****

= ****一個細小而平凡的日常生活場面 / 情境****

For your database, I would count ****5 genuinely distinct core meanings**** for ****scene****:

1. ****a visible real-life situation, moment, or scene****
2. ****a section of a film, play, or story****
3. ****the place where an event, crime, accident, etc. happened****

4. **a social/cultural/activity sphere — music scene, art scene, etc.**
5. **an emotional public display — make/cause a scene**

I would normally merge **visual landscape/view scene** into #1 rather than create a sixth core meaning, and treat **behind the scenes, on the scene,** and **set the scene** as fixed-expression extensions.